

Incident report generated successfully for samplelogs.txt.

DISMISS

← RETURN TO DASHBOARD

↺ RESET SESSION

🖨️ PRINT / SAVE AS PDF

INCIDENT SECURITY AUDIT REPORT

CYBERSECURITY INCIDENT RESPONSE SHEET

REPORT REF: IR-20231027-4821

GENERATED DATE (UTC)

27/10/2023, 6:04:56 PM

THREAT RISK INDEX

95/100 (Critical)

1. EXECUTIVE BRIEFING

A critical multi-stage malware attack, identified as an Advanced Persistent Threat (APT), originated from a successful phishing attempt targeting user 'alice' on 'HR-PC07'. This led to initial system compromise, establishing Command and Control (C2) communications, attempting privilege escalation on 'DC01', and initiating mass file copy and sensitive data exfiltration from 'FILE-SRV02'. The incident poses a severe risk of data breach and significant operational disruption, necessitating immediate and comprehensive remediation.

2. TECHNICAL DIAGNOSTICS & VECTOR

The incident began with an initial access vector via a phishing email from 'unknown@evilmail.com' containing 'invoice.zip', which user 'alice' executed on 'HR-PC07'. This resulted in the execution of 'invoice.exe' and subsequent malicious PowerShell activity ('powershell.exe -EncodedCommand IEX'), leading to a 'Trojan.Generic' detection. Following the compromise, 'HR-PC07' established Command and Control (C2) by resolving 'evil-command-control.example' and connecting to '185.220.101.15' on port 443. This C2 communication facilitated an unauthorized privilege escalation attempt on 'DC01' using the 'svc_backup' account and later, mass file copying and sensitive data transfer activities on 'FILE-SRV02' by user 'charlie', indicating an intent for data exfiltration. Rapid response actions included isolation of 'HR-PC07', blocking the C2 domain, and resetting 'alice's password, but the potential for broader impact remains high.

3. INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE (IOCS)

IP Addresses 192.168.1.77 185.220.101.15	Network Assets (Domains/URLs) evil-command-control.example	Target Vulnerability / CVEs No vulnerability indicators logged.
--	--	---

4. MITRE ATT&CK® MATRIX MAPPING

Tactic Category	Technique Name	Technique ID
Execution	PowerShell	T1059.001

Adversaries may abuse PowerShell to execute commands and scripts. PowerShell is a powerful interactive command-line interface and scripting environment included in Windows, which can be leveraged for various malicious activities including code execution, reconnaissance, and persistence.

5. EVENT CHRONOLOGY TIMELINE

- 2026-07-08 09:07:18

User 'alice' logged into mailbox on 'MAIL-SRV01'.
- 2026-07-08 09:09:41

Suspicious PowerShell execution by user 'alice' on 'HR-PC07' with encoded command.
- 2026-07-08 09:09:56

Critical alert for Suspicious PowerShell Activity on 'HR-PC07'.
- 2026-07-08 09:10:42

Malware 'Trojan.Generic' detected by Defender on 'HR-PC07'.
- 2026-07-08 09:10:45

Malicious file 'C:\Users\alice\Downloads\invoice.exe' quarantined on 'HR-PC07'.
- 2026-07-08 09:12:07

DNS query for malicious domain 'evil-command-control.example' successfully resolved.
- 2026-07-08 09:12:15

Critical alert for outbound connection from 'HR-PC07' to '185.220.101.15' on port 443 (C2 communication).
- 2026-07-08 09:12:28

Firewall allowed outbound connection from '192.168.1.77' (HR-PC07) to '185.220.101.15' on port 443.
- 2026-07-08 09:13:55

Privilege Escalation requested by user 'svc_backup' on 'DC01'.

- 2026-07-08 09:14:03

Alert for Unauthorized Privilege Escalation by 'svc_backup' on 'DC01'.
- 2026-07-08 09:17:25

User 'charlie' accessed 'Payroll.xlsx' on 'FILE-SRV02'.
- 2026-07-08 09:18:11

Warning for Mass File Copy activity by user 'charlie' on 'FILE-SRV02'.
- 2026-07-08 09:18:47

DLP alert for Sensitive Data Transfer detected on 'FILE-SRV02'.
- 2026-07-08 09:19:12

Email Gateway log showing email from 'unknown@evilmail.com' with 'invoice.zip' attachment.
- 2026-07-08 09:19:24

Sandbox verdict: SHA256 '8f4d5b3ac0fcb1d1ab3f6d89a51d9b5d6d52f6a3c1f4c84b2e8e7b9c5d1a3f21' (from 'invoice.zip') is malicious.
- 2026-07-08 09:20:00

'HR-PC07' isolation enabled via EDR.
- 2026-07-08 09:21:15

Malicious destination domain 'evil-command-control.example' blocked by firewall.
- 2026-07-08 09:22:03

Password reset completed for user 'alice'.
- 2026-07-08 09:23:18

Incident 'INC-1042' declared Contained with High severity.

6. RECOMMENDED CONTAINMENT AUDIT

- ☐ Verify complete network isolation of 'HR-PC07', 'DC01', and 'FILE-SRV02' to prevent further lateral movement and impact.
- ☐ Force immediate password resets and enforce Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) for all potentially compromised accounts, specifically 'alice', 'svc_backup', and 'charlie'.
- ☐ Confirm persistent blocks for the C2 domain 'evil-command-control.example' and IP '185.220.101.15' on all network security devices (firewall, IDS/IPS).

7. POST-INCIDENT RECOVERY & ERADICATION

- Conduct immediate and thorough forensic analysis on 'HR-PC07', 'DC01', and 'FILE-SRV02' to identify the full compromise scope, persistence mechanisms, and any additional compromised accounts or systems.
- Analyze email logs for other recipients of emails from 'unknown@evilmail.com' or with 'invoice.zip' to identify and remediate other potentially compromised users/hosts.
- Enhance email security gateway rules to permanently block 'unknown@evilmail.com' and any attachments matching SHA256 '8f4d5b3ac0fcb1d1ab3f6d89a51d9b5d6d52f6a3c1f4c84b2e8e7b9c5d1a3f21'.
- Review and harden security configurations on 'DC01' and 'FILE-SRV02' to prevent future privilege escalation and unauthorized data access/exfiltration attempts. Implement the Principle of Least Privilege for all service accounts.
- Conduct a comprehensive data breach assessment to confirm what sensitive data was potentially exfiltrated from 'FILE-SRV02' and initiate appropriate legal and customer notifications if confirmed.
- Implement advanced PowerShell logging and auditing across all endpoints to better detect and prevent similar execution techniques.
- Provide mandatory security awareness training to all employees, focusing on phishing recognition and safe attachment handling.

8. THREAT INTEL & FORENSIC NOTES

This incident exhibits characteristics of an Advanced Persistent Threat (APT), employing a multi-stage attack chain starting with phishing (T1566.001) for initial access. The execution involved malicious attachments (T1204.002) and sophisticated PowerShell command-line obfuscation (T1059.001), indicating an adversary skilled in bypassing basic detection mechanisms. Subsequent activities included establishing Command and Control (T1071.001, T1090.003) via HTTPS to 'evil-command-control.example' (185.220.101.15), followed by potential lateral movement and an attempt at privilege escalation on the Domain Controller (T1068, T1078.002) using the 'svc_backup' account. The final observed stages involved data collection (T1119) through mass file copying and attempted exfiltration (T1041, T1567) of sensitive data from 'FILE-SRV02'. Further forensic investigation is critical to uncover the full extent of the compromise, persistence mechanisms, and the identities/motives of the threat actor. The 'svc_backup' account's involvement is highly suspicious and requires immediate audit and review of its permissions.

